

Nexora Corporate Knowledge Base: Deployment SOP

Target Role: DEVOPS,ENGINEERING | Version: Official | Published: 2026-09-25

1. Deployment Schedule & Cadence

Standard production deployments take place on Tuesdays and Thursdays between 10:00 AM and 2:00 PM EST. Friday deployments, weekend deployments, and deployments after 3:00 PM EST are strictly prohibited to prevent off-hours incidents.

2. Emergency Out-of-Band Hotfixes

Emergency hotfixes outside the scheduled deployment window require explicit written approval from the Engineering VP or Director of Infrastructure in the #hotfix-approvals channel.

3. Progressive Rollout & Canary Strategy

Deployments follow a canary progression: 5% traffic for 15 minutes -> 25% for 30 minutes -> 100% full rollout. Automated health checks monitor HTTP 5xx error rates, latency p99, and CPU/memory saturation.

4. Automated Rollback Criteria

If error rates exceed 0.5% or p99 latency increases by >25% during canary rollout, the automated CD pipeline immediately triggers a 1-click rollback to the previous stable release artifact.

6. Holiday and Event Freezes

The Engineering VP may declare deployment freezes around major holidays or company events. Freeze calendars are published at least 2 weeks in advance; only Sev1 hotfixes with written approval ship during a freeze.

7. Database Migration Safety

Schema migrations must be backward-compatible across at least one release (expand-then-contract). Destructive migrations require a reviewed rollback plan and a dedicated maintenance window.

8. Feature Flags and Kill Switches

User-facing changes ship behind feature flags with a documented kill switch. Any engineer can request a flag-off through the Incident Commander during a suspected incident without prior approval.